LADY SHRI RAM COLLEGE FOR WOMEN

UNIVERSITY OF DELHI

DEPARTMENT OF B.A PROGRAMME

SAMAGAM'26

presents

REVIVE THE FAILED

A BUSINESS CASE COMPETITION

REVIVE THE FAILED ’26

ROUND 1 - DIAGNOSE & REIMAGINE

OBJECTIVE

Teams will select one business from the list provided by the organisers and analyse its decline while operating within the original circumstances of its failure. The list of the failed start-ups/companies is given at the end of this document.

The objective is **not to replace the business with a new model**, but to identify how the existing business could have adapted, responded and survived while retaining its fundamental identity.

SUBMISSION

Teams must submit a **3-slide case deck**, excluding the cover slide, thank-you page and appendix. The appendix is optional.

ROUND 1 DELIVERABLES

Slide 1: Executive Summary

Teams must establish the context of the case by presenting:

- **The Business:** What the company did, its original value proposition and core business model.
- **The Market:** Its target customers, market position and key competitors at the time of its decline.
- **The Failure Context:** The primary challenge or turning point that contributed to its decline.
- **The Revival Thesis:** A one-line statement of what the company could have done differently while retaining its fundamental business identity.

Slide 2: Why Did It Fail?

Teams must diagnose the failure rather than merely describe it.

The analysis must identify:

- **Root Cause(s):** What fundamentally caused the business to decline?
- **Critical Decisions:** Which strategic, marketing, operational or other decisions accelerated the decline?

- **Failed Assumptions:** Which assumptions about customers, markets, technology, competition or operations proved incorrect?
- **The Unavoidable Problem:** What specific challenge must the company have confronted to survive?
- **Missed Opportunities:** What realistic opportunities existed to respond to this challenge?
- **Point of Intervention:** At what stage could a different decision realistically have changed the trajectory?

Slide 3: What Could Have Been Done Differently?

Teams must present a **revival thesis**, not a replacement business.

The proposed solution must demonstrate:

- **The Strategic Intervention:** What should the company have done differently?
- **Problem-Solution Fit:** How does the proposed intervention directly address the identified root cause?
- **Continuity:** How does the solution preserve the company's fundamental business model, identity and core value proposition?
- **Adaptation:** How would the business respond to the same market, technological, operational, labour or competitive challenge that contributed to its failure?
- **Revival Outcome:** What would the business realistically look like if the intervention had been implemented?
- **Initial Roadmap:** What key steps are required to put the proposed solution into action?
- **Feasibility:** Why could this solution realistically have worked given the business' resources and circumstances?

Round 1 Boundary

Teams **may evolve, reposition, rebrand, modify, optimise or restructure** the existing business. However, teams **may not eliminate the central problem, replace the original business with an unrelated model, or assume circumstances that remove the challenge altogether.**

The test is simple: **Same business. Same core identity. Same problem. Different responses.**

SUBMISSION GUIDELINES

- Submission Format: PDF
- File Naming Format: TeamName_Round1_ReviveTheFailed26
- Submission: Only one member per team must submit the solution via **Unstop**
- The submission must strictly adhere to the problem statement, challenges and components specified in the case.
- Teams have creative freedom in the presentation and are encouraged to present their ideas in innovative and engaging ways, while ensuring that the substance of their analysis remains clear.
- Team decks should focus on the business analysis of the startup, including its business model, market position, challenges, financial viability, and potential for revival. Legal complications and allegations must not be an influencing factor.
- Teams are discouraged from using Generative AI for their case deck.
- No extension or separate deadline will be provided for any submission. Failure to submit within the prescribed submission window will result in cancellation of the team's participation in the competition.
- Sources, if used, must be clearly cited in the submission. Plagiarism will lead to immediate disqualification.
- The decision of the organising team shall be final and binding on all the participants.

APPENDIX : LIST OF FAILED START-UPS

1. DOODHWALA



Founders Aakash Agarwal and Ebrahim Akbari

Founded: 2015

Headquarters: Bengaluru, Karnataka, India

Purpose: Subscription-based delivery of **fresh milk and daily essentials** directly to homes, mainly before 7 AM. The subscription model meant customers could have milk delivered automatically, while also adding other groceries to upcoming deliveries. This created **frequent, recurring interactions with the customer** rather than occasional grocery orders.

Operational Reach: Bengaluru, Pune, and Hyderabad

Current status - Operations shut down in **2019**; FreshToHome took over its delivery operations

2. STAYZILLA

Founded: 2005 as Inasra Technologies, later rebranded to Stayzilla in 2010

Founders: Yogendra Vasupal, Sachit Singhi, and Rupal Yogendra.

Purpose: Stayzilla was an Indian online travel tech company and homestay marketplace that connected travelers with budget accommodations and local hosts

Headquarters: Chennai, Tamil Nadu, India.

Current status: Shut down in 2017

3. FASHIONARA

Founded: Launched in 2012

Founders: Arun Sirdeshmukh (former CEO of Reliance Trends) and Darpan Munjal (former CTO of Times Internet)

Purpose: Operated as an online "eMall" focused on premium and luxury fashion brands across apparel, footwear, and accessories for men, women, and children.

Headquarters - Bengaluru, Karnataka, India.

Current status - Operations shut down May 2016

4. LOCAL BANYA



Founded: May 2012

Founders: Karan Mehrotra, Rashi Choudhary, and Amit Naik.

Purpose: As Mumbai's first major online grocery platform, its core mission was to address the daily friction points of urban life, such as crowded markets, long billing lines, traffic, and haggling, by offering hassle-free, doorstep delivery of household essentials.

Headquarters: Mumbai, India.

Current status: Operations suspended in Oct 2015

5. **BHARATAGRI**

Founded: April 2017

Founders: Siddharth Dialani & Sai Gole.

Purpose: Use **technology and personalised farm advice** to help farmers improve yields, reduce costs, and make better decisions about crops, irrigation and inputs.

Started / HQ: Pune; later had an office in **Bengaluru** and operated across India.

Current Status: Shut down in November 2025

6. **KOO**

Founded: 2019; **launched:** March 2020

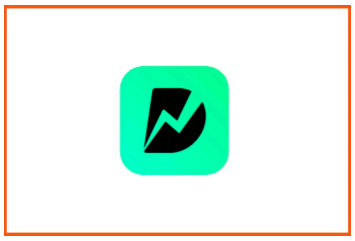
Founders: Aprameya Radhakrishna & Mayank Bidawatka

Purpose: An Indian **multilingual microblogging platform**, designed as an alternative to Twitter/X and to make online expression easier in **Indian languages** rather than being primarily English-based.

Started / HQ: Bengaluru, Karnataka

Current Status: Shut down July 2024

7. DUNZO



Founders: Kabeer Biswas, Ankur Agarwal, Dalvir Suri, and Mukund Jha.

Headquarters: Bengaluru, Karnataka, India.

Founded: 2014/2015 - began as a **WhatsApp-based service in Bengaluru**, incorporated as a company in 2015.

Purpose A hyperlocal on-demand delivery service where users could ask Dunzo to pick up, buy or deliver almost anything within the city, such as groceries, medicines, food, packages and forgotten items.

Started in: Bengaluru

Current Status: Shut down in January 2025
